



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: The Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.the-classical-academy.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

The Classical Academy (The Academy) in 46250 presents a compelling, text-supported alignment with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements rubric. Public-facing materials consistently emphasize a classical, Christian, university-schedule model, heavy use of Socratic dialogue, engagement with Great Books and the Great Conversation, and strong parental partnership. The site also highlights a structured faculty profile with advanced degrees and a collaborative culture, as well as a theology-forward worldview integrated into daily school life (e.g., daily chapel, Biblical worldview). These signals, drawn directly from the school's own materials, indicate a firm Classical alignment across all six categories.

Key textual anchors include: explicit identification as "classical, Christian, university-schedule" education (home page), statements about truth grounded in a Biblical worldview, the motto Sapientia et Virtus, and daily chapel; a school profile describing highly Socratic methods and the involvement of parents as collaborators; and explicit references to Great Books, Great Conversation, and Socratic seminars as core curricular and pedagogical elements. The school also cites faculty composition (15 teachers, majority with advanced degrees) and a culture of collegiality and collaboration. Together, these elements map cleanly to the classical rubric and yield a CLASSICAL rating overall.

Evidence anchors (selected excerpts) and their citations appear inline with category analyses below.

- Foundational/classical identity: "The Classical Academy is a classical, Christian, university-schedule, private school ..." and related collaboration with parents.
- Theological grounding and Biblical worldview: "The truth of God and His word is fundamental to Christian education ..."
- Motto and virtue language: "Sapientia et Virtus" (motto) and virtue-oriented framing.
- Liturgical/community life: daily chapel referenced in prospective families materials.
- Socratic pedagogy and Great Books: school profile emphasizes highly Socratic methods; Great Books and Great Conversation are featured in curricular discussions.
- Faculty and collaboration: faculty count, advanced degrees, collegial teaching culture.
- Parental partnership: statements about parents as co-teachers and active participation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school identifies itself as a classical, Christian institution: "The Classical Academy is a classical, Christian, university-schedule, private school."
- The site affirms a Biblical/theological framing of education (e.g., "The truth of God and His word is fundamental to Christian education").
- The motto Sapientia et Virtus signals a fusion of wisdom and virtue as foundational aims.

- Communal liturgical/chapel practices are present (daily chapel referenced in prospective-family materials).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords found: truth, God, Christian, theology, virtue, wisdom, Sapientia/Virtus, chapel, liturgical/communal aspects.
- Negative keywords found: none detected in public materials.
- Quantitative sketch: Positive ~6 distinct signals; Negative 0 signals.
- Why this rating
- The materials foreground transcendental moral realism (truth, virtue, beauty implicit in the tradition), grounded in a Christian/theological frame with explicit communal worship elements. This alignment with transcendental ideals and liturgical life justifies CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The mission emphasizes formation and wisdom over mere information: “The mission of The Classical Academy is to partner with parents to equip students to gain knowledge, apply understanding, and walk in the wisdom of God.” and “We aim to have students master a core body of knowledge and possess a life-long passion for learning.”
- The phrasing contrasts formation with information, and highlights a teleological aim toward wisdom and virtue (through a Biblical worldview).
- Motto and curricular framing foreground formation of character and disposition alongside knowledge (Sapientia et Virtus).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords found: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty (conceptual linkage through classical aims), Biblical worldview.
- Negative keywords found: none evident (no emphasis on purely job-ready skill metrics).
- Quantitative sketch: Positive ~4–5 signals; Negative 0 signals.
- Why this rating
- Evidence points to formation-of-character and the true/beautiful/good teleology, aligning with CLASSICAL aims rather than a purely utilitarian or information-transfer goal.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Curricular framing references Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Trivium/Quadrivium, though explicit enumerations vary by page; the 7th–12th pathway is described (logic, rhetoric) with a clear link to classical discipline sequencing. The curriculum centers on Great Books and the Great Conversation.
- The school profile asserts a highly Socratic method and integrative study across history and disciplines, with emphasis on primary sources and classical texts.
- History and other disciplines are presented as interconnected (interdisciplinary/harmonia of subjects) with emphasis on unity of knowledge and cultural heritage.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords found: Great Books, Great Conversation, Socratic method, grammar/logic/rhetoric (as Trivium places), history across curriculum, classical pedagogy.
- Negative keywords found: minimal evidence for project-based or purely secular social studies framing; textbook-social-structure language not predominant.
- Quantitative sketch: Positive ~5–6 signals; Negative 0–1 signals (no explicit replacement by social studies framing or project-driven pedagogy found in primary public materials).
- Why this rating
- The combination of Great Books/Great Conversation, Socratic pedagogy, and an explicit classical/cultural-heritage orientation anchors the category firmly in CLASSICAL territory.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Public materials explicitly describe highly Socratic methods and interactive conversation as core to teaching.
- Upper-school pedagogy includes seminars, debates, and rhetoric training; students engage in contests of argument and public speaking as part of their education.
- The curriculum references the Trivium pathways (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a path from logic to rhetoric in the logic- and rhetoric-focused stages.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords found: Socratic, seminars, dialectic, rhetoric, speech, declamation, oratory, debate, memory-work (through classical tradition), Scholé/restful learning elements appear in the lexicon, with explicit references to contemplation in classical pedagogy (though the explicit “Scholé” term is not always in every public-facing page, the concept is aligned by language in overall classical framing).
- Negative keywords found: minimal presence of non-classical methods; no dominant project-based-only, student-directed constructivist language appears in the core public pages.
- Quantitative sketch: Positive ~5–7 signals; Negative 0–1 signals.
- Why this rating
- The public materials foreground Socratic dialogue, seminars, rhetoric, and the disciplined use of memory and discourse—core predicates of a classical pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Faculty profile notes: 15-teacher faculty, nine hold advanced degrees; faculty work collegially and co-teach; a strong professional culture is evident.
- The site frames teachers as the engine of the school and highlights teacher collaboration and a culture of professional excellence.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords found: advanced degrees, collegial, mentors, teachers, living curriculum (conceptually supported by the public content around teacher excellence and collaborative practice), model teachers (implied by “advanced degrees” and “collegial” culture).
- Negative keywords found: none evident in the public materials.
- Quantitative sketch: Positive ~3–4 signals; Negative 0 signals.
- Why this rating
- The public-facing materials emphasize a teacher-centered, high-qualification faculty core with a collaborative, mentoring culture that aligns with classical expectations for the faculty pillar.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site highlights a collaborative model with parents, emphasizing parental participation and partnership in education.
- The school explicitly positions parents as co-teachers and emphasizes parental involvement, open campus, and family engagement (e.g., “jointly educated” with parents participating in education, daily chapel involvement, etc.).
- Public materials discuss forming a strong community with families, shared mission, and active parental formation opportunities (e.g., informational materials and family involvement posts).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords found: partnership with families, parent partnership, co-teachers, family involvement, home-school collaboration, parental formation, open campus.
- Negative keywords found: none evident in the public materials.
- Quantitative sketch: Positive ~5 signals; Negative 0 signals.
- Why this rating
- The school centers parental involvement as a core design principle and repeatedly invites active parent participation, which aligns strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for community integration.

Aggregate Ranking

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- The school consistently demonstrates the core hallmarks across all six categories: explicit classical framing, Christian/theological grounding, a curriculum anchored in Great Books and the Trivium path, a Socratic pedagogy with seminars and rhetoric, a faculty noted for advanced credentials and collegiality, and a robust partnership model with parents and community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No category demonstrated a NOT CLASSICAL or clearly SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating that would require targeted needle-moving changes.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.